MISSION BAY NEWS
Mobile Home Community

1971 *December 2025*

Monthly Newsletter

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PARK SECURITY

If you see anyone who looks like they do not belong in the park, especially at an odd hour, CALL 911 FIRST

The San Leandro Police has advised us to leave our front and back porch light on all night.
NON-EMERGENCY number for the police dept. is (510) 577-2740

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We wish you a merry christmas, we wish you a merry christmas, we wish you a merry christmas and a Happy New Year...

Mission Bay News Crew

Many thanks to our News Crew who organize and deliver our monthly magazine rain or shine! You are appreciated!

Alice Leung	Coordinator
Brenda Gianni	Activity Calendar
Vince Crabill	Distribution
Michael Garris	1 thru 33 | 501 thru 541
James Gamble	50 thru 72 | 150 thru 197
Vince Crabill	101 thru 145
Marta Barnes	201 thru 239
Rosita Gee	250 thru 289
Nancy Garrett	301 thru 338
Irene Zhong	350 thru 387
Darrin McWilliams	401 thru 440
Angie Chan	450 thru 491

BIRTHDAYS & ANNIVERSARIES

DECEMBER *Birthdays*

Tom Joseph	3rd
Liu Hui Ling	5th
Dick Covell	10th
Nancy Luu	12th
Dean McWilliams	13th
Arturo Sanchez	15th
Angie Kwok	16th
Steven Buresh	19th
Rosita Gee	19th
Linda Lepore	22nd
Cathy Garaventa	25th
David Remundo	25th
Darlene Buresh	29th

DECEMBER *Anniversaries*

Ernie & Rose Chaffee	16th
Peter & Penny Gallick	28th



ACTIVITY CALENDAR

DECEMBER 2025



SUN.	MON.	TUES.	WED.	THURS.	FRI.	SAT.
	1 EXERCISE CLASS 9:30-10:30	2 CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	3 EXERCISE CLASS 9:30-10:30 TAI CHI 10:30 – 11 MEX TRAIN 1:30-3:30 POKER GAME 12-3:30	4 TAI CHI 10:00-10:30 CARD GAME 12 – 4:30 (Crafts Rm) CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	5 EXERCISE CLASS 9:30-10:30 POKEENO 5 – 7:30 RECYCLE	6 TAI CHI 10 – 11
7	8 EXERCISE CLASS 9:30-10:30	9 CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	10 EXERCISE CLASS 9:30-10:30 TAI CHI 10:30 – 11 MEX TRAIN 1:30-3:30 POKER GAME 12-3:30	11 TAI CHI 10:00-10:30 BOOK CLUB 1 pm (Crafts Rm) CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	12 EXERCISE CLASS 9:30-10:30 POKEENO 5 – 7:30	13 MBRA MTG 10 - 11
14	15 EXERCISE CLASS 9:30-10:30	16 CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	17 EXERCISE CLASS 9:30-10:30 TAI CHI 10:30 – 11 MEX TRAIN 1:30-3:30 POKER GAME 12-3:30	18 TAI CHI 10-10:30 CARD GAME 12 – 4:30 (Crafts Rm) CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	19 EXERCISE CLASS 9:30-10:30 POKEENO 5 – 7:30 BIBLE STUDY 6:30 pm RECYCLE	20 TAI CHI 10 – 11 M & W THANKSGIVING DINNER 2-4
21 PRIVATE EVENT ALL DAY Winter Solstice	22 EXERCISE CLASS 9:30-10:30	23 CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	24 EX CLASS 9:30-10:30 TAI CHI 10:30 – 11 MEX TRAIN 1:30-3:30 POKER GAME 12-3:30	25 TAI CHI 10-10:30 CARD GAME 12 – 4:30 (Crafts Rm) CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	26 EXERCISE CLASS 9:30-10:30 POKEENO 5 – 7:30 BIBLE STUDY 6:30 pm	27 TAI CHI 10 – 11
28	29 EXERCISE CLASS 9:30-10:30	30 CARD GAME 12:30 – 4	31 EX CLASS 9:30-10:30 TAI CHI 10:30 – 11 MEX TRAIN 1:30-3:30 POKER GAME 12-3:30			

VIEU NEWS

BY PETER CLEAVELAND

Time For A Reappraisal

This year's Great California ShakeOut on Oct 16 was, to put it mildly, anticlimactic. We were badly short of block captains, and when they canvassed their areas they found few OK/**NEED HELP** signs displayed.

We're increasing our efforts to recruit more block captains, but one of those we have made an interesting discovery. She went from door to door in her area and asked people who had not displayed the signs why they had not done so.

The answers were a revelation: Many people had no signs, and they and some others didn't know what the signs are for. Here's what the signs are for:To put it briefly, the signs can save your life. When an earthquake comes the block captains will have their hands full taking care of the injured and others who need help. Residents can help them by letting them know who needs help and who does not, by displaying the signs in their front windows. That way we won't waste time checking on people who don't need our help.

During the annual ShakeOut drill, we ask all residents to put up their signs to show they are participating and that they know what to do.

Do you have a sign?

We just had a pile of new signs printed up, and there are enough for everyone.

If you don't have a sign, please get one, and keep it where you can get at it when the time comes. We keep a stack of them in the main hall of the Clubhouse, below the window to the office. We also have copies of the Earthquake Brochure, which gives a great deal of information about how to prepare for an earthquake and what to do when it comes. Come and get your copy, and read it to make sure you know what to do.

VIEU 新闻

是时候重新评估了

今年的“大加州地震演习”（Great California ShakeOut）于10月16日举行，说得委婉一点，结果相当平淡。我们的街区队长人数严重不足，而他们在巡视辖区时发现，很少有人在窗前张贴“安全 / 需要帮助”（OK/**NEED HELP**） 的标志。

我们正在加大力度招募更多的街区队长，而现有的一位队长却有了一个有趣的发现。她挨家挨户走访，询问那些没有张贴标志的居民为何没有这样做。

答案令人惊讶：许多人根本没有标志，而他们以及其他一些人甚至不知道这些标志是做什么用的。

这些标志的用途如下：

简单来说，这些标志可以挽救你的生命。当地震发生时，街区队长将忙于照顾伤者及其他需要帮助的人。居民可以通过在自家窗前张贴标志，告知他们谁需要帮助、谁不需要帮助。这样一来，我们就不会浪费时间去查看那些并不需要援助的住户。

在每年的地震演习中，我们会请所有居民张贴标志，以表明他们参与了演习，并且知道在地震时该怎么做。

你有标志吗？

我们刚刚印制了一批新标志，足够每位居民领取。

如果你还没有标志，请尽快领取一个，并放在容易拿到的地方，以便需要时能迅速使用。我们在会所（Clubhouse）主厅内、办公室窗口下方放有一叠标志。同时，我们还备有《地震宣传手册》（Earthquake Brochure），其中详细介绍了如何做好地震准备，以及地震来临时的应对措施。欢迎前来领取，并仔细阅读，确保你知道在地震时该如何行动。

COMMUNITY SAFETY BULLETIN



CALL FOR BLOCK CAPTAINS

We badly need some new block captains. If you would like to help keep your neighbors safe, please contact Pete Cleaveland at pcleaveland@earthlink.net, 510-351-1742, or by mail at 481 Santa Monica and we'll give you everything you need.

我们急需一些新的街区队长。如果您愿意帮助保护邻居的安全，请联系 Pete Cleaveland，邮箱：pcleaveland@earthlink.net，电话：510-351-1742，或邮寄至 481 Santa Monica，我们将竭诚为您提供所需的一切。

Necesitamos urgentemente nuevos capitanes de cuadra. Si desea ayudar a mantener seguros a sus vecinos, por favor, contáctenos Pete Cleaveland at pcleaveland@earthlink.net, 510-351-1742, or by mail at 481 Santa Monica y te daremos todo lo que necesitas.

When disaster strikes—fire, earthquake, or other emergencies—every second counts. Our community needs trained, trusted volunteers to serve as Block Captains: neighbors who walk the block, check on residents, and help coordinate emergency response.

當災難來襲——火災、地震或其他緊急情況——分秒必爭。我們的社區需要訓練有素、□得信賴的志工擔任街區隊長：他們負責在街區巡邏，慰問居民，並協助協調緊急應變

Cuando ocurre un desastre (incendio, terremoto u otras emergencias), cada segundo cuenta. Nuestra comunidad necesita voluntarios capacitados y de confianza que sirvan como Capitanes de Barrio: vecinos que recorren la cuadra, se preocupan por los residentes y ayudan a coordinar la respuesta ante emergencias.

HAPPY HOLIDAYS FROM YOUR MEN AND WOMEN'S CLUB!

Thank you for coming out to the Thanksgiving Gathering Potluck dinner! The food was delicious and we enjoyed a fun evening with our friends and neighbors.

Please join us for our Holiday Party on Saturday, December 20 from 2:00 to 4:00 pm. A delicious lunch will be served and we will have the 50/25/25 raffle drawing and lots of Holiday music! Don't miss out on the fun!

In January we will elect our new officers for the Men and Women's Club at a special meeting on Saturday, January 31 at 11:00 am. (President, Vice President, Secretary and Treasurer)

Please consider taking an office so that we can continue to enjoy the many fun events we have had in the past. (Pancake breakfasts, Ice cream socials, potluck dinners, July 4th BBQs, Asian dinners, Luau parties, Cinco de Mayo celebrations, Thanksgiving and Holiday gatherings and much more!) Nancy Garrett, Judy Dalba and Pam Wright will be happy to explain at the meeting what is involved in being an officer.

Nancy, Pam and I have enjoyed serving on the Board of the Men and Women's Club for the last two years. Also, a great big Thank You goes to the many volunteers who have made our job so much easier!

Happy Holidays!!

PLEASE JOIN US FOR A

Christmas PARTY

DECEMBER 20 AT 2:00 PM

A DELICIOUS LUNCH WILL BE SERVED AND WE WILL HAVE THE 50/25/25 RAFFLE DRAWING AND LOTS OF HOLIDAY MUSIC! DON'T MISS OUT ON THE FUN!

LET'S CELEBRATE!

WORD SEARCH

Christmas

I	K	M	M	D	N	O	D	G	Y	M	A	S	B
J	O	S	A	A	C	L	E	I	T	A	E	N	H
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CANDY CANES
TREE
JOLLY
JACK FROST
GINGERBREAD
SNOWFLAKE
CRACKERS
MANGER
CHRISTMAS
MERRY
FRIENDS
DECORATIONS
NATIVITY
SANTA CLAUS
GIFTS
FAMILY
ANGEL

Cost of In-Home Care California: 11 Ways to Pay for In-Home Care

By Tanner Gish, lovinghomecareinc.com

California's high cost of living extends to in-home care, creating a financial burden for many families. Across California, thousands of families are facing the same dilemma. The state's aging population is growing quickly, and with it, the demand for compassionate, reliable in-home care.

But as the cost of in home care California continues to rise, affording this essential support can feel out of reach. Whether it's for a parent recovering from surgery or a grandparent needing daily assistance, the financial burden can be overwhelming, leaving families unsure how to make the best decisions for their loved ones.

California's senior population is rapidly increasing. By 2030, the number of residents aged 65 and older is expected to reach 8.6 million, from 12% in 2012 to 19% of the state's total population.

This guide answers the question 'how much does in home care cost' and provides a detailed breakdown of affordable in-home care California options, including 11 payment methods ranging from government aid to private financing

Understanding the Cost of In-Home Care in California



California's in-home care costs rank among the highest in the nation, presenting financial challenges for families. According to recent home care statistics, average costs have risen sharply due to increased demand and a growing senior population.

Average Cost of In-Home Care in California

- Hourly Rates: Typically $32–$40 per hour statewide.
- Monthly Costs: For part-time care (40 hours per week), expect to pay $6,600–$6,800 per month. Around-the-clock (24/7) care can exceed $27,000 per month.

Cost Variation by Location

- Los Angeles: Approximately $40 per hour; around $6,400 per month (40 hours/week) San Francisco: Higher rates, often above the state average
- San Diego: Moderate rates, approximately $4,200 per month
- Sacramento & Rural Areas: Lower rates, ranging from $3,200 to $3,800 per month

Key Factors Affecting Cost

Type of Care:

- Non-Medical (Companion): $20–$30 per hour
- Personal Care Assistance: $25–$40 per hour
- Skilled Nursing (Medical): $40–$75 per hour

Location: Urban areas generally cost more than rural regions.

Caregiver Experience: Specialized or highly experienced caregivers command higher rates.

Care Duration: Full-time (24/7) care is significantly more expensive than part-time care.

11 Ways to Pay for In-Home Care



1. Private Pay (Out-of-Pocket Payments)

Many families in California pay directly for in home care services. The median hourly rate for non-medical in-home care in California is about $35 per hour in 2025, with monthly costs for 40 hours per week ranging from approximately $4,000 to $6,400, depending on the level of care and location.

Budgeting tips:

- Assess care needs carefully to avoid overpaying.
- Consider part-time care to reduce costs.
- Compare rates among local providers, as costs vary widely by region (e.g., $3,175/month in Fresno vs. $5,200/month in San Francisco).

Pros: Full control over provider choice and care schedule.
Cons: Can be very expensive and quickly deplete saving

2. Long-Term Care Insurance

Long-term care insurance (LTCI) helps cover the cost of in-home care, assisted living, or nursing home care. In California, LTCI policies include personal care services such as bathing, dressing, and medication management. However, coverage and premiums vary.

Pros: Can reduce out-of-pocket expenses if purchased early.
Cons: Premiums can be high; many policies have strict eligibility criteria and waiting periods.

3. Medicare

Medicare provides limited coverage for in-home care, mainly for skilled nursing or therapy services following hospitalization, and only for a short duration (usually up to 100 days). It does not cover long-term personal or custodial care.

Pros: Covers medically necessary skilled care.
Cons: Very limited coverage for ongoing in-home care needs.

4. Medicaid (Medi-Cal in California)

Medi-Cal offers support for low-income seniors and disabled individuals, including In-Home Supportive Services (IHSS) that help pay for personal care at home. Eligibility is based on income and assets, and services must be medically necessary.

Pros: Can cover extensive in-home care costs for eligible individuals.
Cons: Strict income limits and a complex application process; not all services are covered.

5. Veterans' Benefits

California veterans and their surviving spouses qualify for VA Aid and Attendance benefits, which provide monthly payments to help cover in-home care costs. Eligibility depends on service history and financial need.

Pros: Can provide financial support.
Cons: Requires documentation and eligibility verification; benefits vary.

6. Health Savings Accounts (HSA) and Flexible Spending Accounts (FSA)

Families can use HSA or FSA funds to pay for qualified in-home care expenses, including medical and some personal care services. HSAs offer tax advantages and allow funds to roll over, while FSAs follow a "use-it-or-lose-it" rule.

Pros: Tax-advantaged method for covering care expenses.
Cons: Limited annual contribution limits; FSAs have strict usage deadlines.

7. Reverse Mortgages

Homeowners aged 62 and older in California can access their home equity through a reverse mortgage to fund in-home care. This provides cash flow without monthly mortgage payments but reduces the home's equity.
Pros: Offers liquidity without monthly payments.
Cons: Reduces inheritance; fees and interest can be high.

8. Caregiver Tax Deductions

Families who hire caregivers directly qualify for tax deductions or credits, such as the Child and Dependent Care Credit or medical expense deductions, if the caregiver is a medical professional.

Pros: Can reduce the overall tax burden.
Cons: Requires detailed record-keeping and proof of eligibility.

9. Nonprofit and State Programs
Various nonprofit and state-run programs in California offer financial assistance or subsidized in-home care, including services provided by Area Agencies on Aging and community organizations.

Pros: Provide free or low-cost support.
Cons: Availability varies by region; some programs have long waitlists.

10. Payment Plans from Home Care Agencies
Some California home care agencies offer flexible payment plans or sliding-scale fees. Families should ask about these options when evaluating care providers.

Pros: Helps make payments more manageable.
Cons: Include interest or service fees; not all agencies offer these options.

11. Crowdfunding
Many families turn to crowdfunding platforms such as GoFundMe to raise money for in-home care expenses. While not a guaranteed source, it can be a helpful supplement.

Pros: Can quickly mobilize community support.
Cons: Success depends on social network and campaign visibility.

How to Choose the Right Payment Option for Your Family?

Assess Finances and Eligibility
Review income, savings, and insurance to determine what in-home care financial assistance is available. Low-income families might qualify for Medi-Cal's IHSS program, while veterans should explore VA Aid and Attendance benefits.

Determine Care Needs
Costs rise with care intensity. Basic companionship is cheaper than dementia care or 24/7 nursing. Programs like Medi-Cal waivers can cover high-level care.

Consider Location and Provider Type
Urban areas like San Francisco are costlier than rural regions. Agencies offer convenience and support, but cost more. Independent caregivers are cheaper but need more family oversight.

Plan for Sustainability
Combine payment methods, private pay, insurance, and public aid for balance. Use HSAs/FSAs to reduce taxable income. Reverse mortgages help homeowners access funds.

Conclusion:
Navigating the high cost of in-home care in California can feel overwhelming, but there are multiple ways to make it manageable. From private pay and long-term care insurance to government assistance programs like Medi-Cal and VA benefits, families have a variety of options to explore.

Types of Senior Care in California

When you think of long-term care, what comes to mind? For a lot of people, it's nursing homes.

However, most long-term care doesn't take place in nursing homes. In fact, you may never need to live in a nursing home, even if you or a loved one needs frequent long-term care assistance.

Far more care takes place in the home by a personal caregiver, or in other facility types. Long-term care is a spectrum, and below, are a few of the most popular options available:

Adult Day Care

Adult day care centers can provide basic health services and an interactive, social environment for seniors without the permanent resident costs of other facility types.

These centers provide valuable care and socialization benefits during the day and allow care recipients to go back to their homes each night instead of moving into the care facility.

Home Health Aide

Home health aides, or personal care aides, assist with the activities of daily living (ADLs) we mentioned earlier. They may provide in-home assistance for eating, bathing, dressing, and other daily activities as needed.

Homemaker Services

Homemakers, much like a home health aide, provide in-home care, but homemakers have tasks unrelated to ADLs. These could include cleaning, meal preparation, laundry, and other basic household chores or errands that the care recipient is unable to accomplish on their own.

Continuing Care Retirement Communities

Continuing care retirement communities (CCRCs) are composed of multiple facility types, usually including independent living, assisted living, and skilled nursing facility care.

These facility types are all within one community, and residents can move between the levels of care as needed, knowing they will remain in the same community.

Memory Care Facilities

Facilities specializing in those with Alzheimer's disease, dementia, and other cognitive impairment issues. Some of the facility types listed here, such as assisted living centers or nursing homes, can have specialized memory care services.

Rehabilitation Facilities

Rehabilitation centers specialize in the rehabilitation of older adults after surgery, injury, or due to chronic or long-term conditions.

Rehabs may provide a blend of medical care and custodial care, with the ultimate goal of returning the care recipient to a previous level of health or improving their condition enough to transition back home or to a different long-term care facility.

Independent Living Facilities

Independent living facilities are communities for seniors who do not need assistance with basic living tasks. These facilities do not explicitly provide long-term care services. However, residents are free to hire their own private care provider if they need help but wish to remain in the same community.

Besides the long-term care aspects, independent living facilities are very similar to assisted living facilities. Residents live in a community setting, with opportunities for recreation and socialization throughout their day. Many independent living communities also offer meal services or transportation services, though this varies depending on the community.

Assisted Living Facilities

Assisted living facilities (ALFs) These centers assist residents with ADLs but allow them to live as independently as possible. The care needs of those in assisted living centers are less acute than nursing homes, though some assisted living facilities can take care of those with mild cognitive decline.

Assisted living facilities maintain a fully trained staff, 24/7, with a registered nurse on call. All assisted living facilities must provide residents with three meals a day and onsite assistance with medication management.

Nursing Home

Nursing homes offer more skilled medical care for those in greater need of health-related assistance. This is what makes them the most expensive long-term care option listed here.

A nursing home must have trained staff, with a registered nurse (RN) or physician on site and awake, on duty 24 hours a day. A nursing home provides skilled, intermediate, and custodial services in addition to medication management and meals. Nursing homes can handle those with more advanced cognitive decline as well.

Long-Term Care Insurance: 10 Things You Should Know - By David Rodec, kiplinger.com

It can have a high cost and limited choices, but long-term care insurance can make the difference as you age.



Long-term care refers to the services and support needed when a person can't perform at least two activities of daily living, such as bathing, dressing, eating or getting in and out of bed.

When you imagine your retirement journey, you likely picture trips to the beach, leisurely days with the grandkids and lots of time for hobbies. A lengthy stay in a nursing home probably isn't part of that vision. Yet nearly 70% of Americans turning 65 will need some long-term care and support.

"Everyone thinks they'll be in the 30%, but the numbers say to plan otherwise," says Beth Ludden, senior vice president of long-term care product development at Genworth.

The nationwide average daily cost for a shared room in a long-term care facility is $305, with an average annual cost of $111,32, per the most recent data from Genworth's Cost of Care Calculator 2024. The range across the country can vary significantly, from a low of about $175 per day in parts of Texas and Louisiana to approximately $1,000 per day in parts of Alaska and California.

While Medicaid can pay for long-term care, it generally only kicks in after you've spent down virtually all of your assets. Before then, you typically have three options. "You can either pay for everything yourself, a family member can take care of you, or you can buy long-term care insurance," says Jesse Slome, executive director of the American Association for Long-Term Care Insurance.

Long-term care (LTC) insurance can protect your assets so all of your lifelong savings don't go to a facility or home healthcare service. However, these products are expensive and have other limitations.

Here's what to know:

1. Long-term care insurance pays out a set benefit

When you buy LTC insurance, you decide how much coverage you want. It's usually a maximum daily or monthly benefit, such as up to $6,000 per month for a nursing home or a home healthcare worker. Some policies will only reimburse you for what you spend



on care, while others will send you cash for the value of the benefit once you start needing care, regardless of the actual cost.

You also pick a waiting period, during which you need to cover costs before the coverage begins. A ninety-day period is the most common. For an added charge, your coverage amount can increase over time, so that your coverage keeps up with rising costs.

2. Insurers cap your lifetime benefit

Insurers once offered unlimited benefits for long-term care policies, but today, they usually limit payments to three to five years. You also pick the maximum possible payout from the policy. For example, a policy might pay out $165,000 total for care. If you spend past the policy limits, you'll be back on your own.

The policy limits fit the needs of most retirees. Men, on average, need 2.2 years of long-term care, while women, on average, need 3.7 years, based on recent data. About 20% of 65-year-olds end up needing care for five years or longer. Ludden ran into this situation with her mother. "After four years, her policy ran out, and she had to use her funds to cover the facility for two months."

3. Insurance can enhance government benefits

If you have long-term care insurance, you could use the policy to pay for a better facility that doesn't accept Medicaid. If your policy runs out and you do end up going onto Medicaid, some state governments consider whether you bought insurance beforehand, says Genworth's Ludden.

For example, say you buy $250,000 of LTC insurance coverage and spend down the entire policy, forcing you to pay for care with your personal savings. Depending on the state, the government might let you qualify for Medicaid benefits before you spend the last $250,000 of your other assets.

4. Premiums are expensive, especially for women

Long-term care insurance is not a cheap product. The cost depends heavily on your age and gender. A 55-year-old male in standard health would pay $2,075 per year for a $165,000 LTC policy with a 3% inflation rider, growing to about $400,500 by age 85. A 55-year-old female would pay $3,700 per year for the same policy, according to the American Association for Long Term Care Insurance. Women pay more than men because they typically live longer and are more likely to need extended long-term care.

A 65-year-old male would pay $3,280 per year for the same coverage, while a 65-year-old female would pay $5,290 per year. If you're married or in a committed relationship, you can qualify for a discount on a joint policy that covers both of you.

Long-term care insurance policies use level premiums, meaning that after you sign up, the insurer cannot increase the cost based on your age and health. Buying younger can lock in a better deal. Insurers can increase rates for all policyholders but only if they can prove to the government that it's needed to support future payouts, not for extra profits.

5. Prices for newer long-term care insurance policies have stabilized

When LTC insurance first came out, companies didn't properly understand this market and charged too little for the payouts. As a result, they ended up repricing and raising rates for existing policyholders.

"The new policies sold today have factored in the things that caused issues with older policies. While no one can guarantee you won't face a substantial rate increase due to a market adjustment, it's very unlikely," says Slome.

6. You can use partial protection

"LTC insurance doesn't have to be an all-or-nothing proposition," says Slome. If you're concerned about the cost, he suggests getting a policy for a lower amount with the plan to cover the remaining costs with your savings. For example, if you think long-term care will cost you about $6,000 a month, you could get a policy for $3,000 and pay the remaining $3,000 out of your assets.

There are also short-term care policies that only pay out benefits for one year but cost much less than long-term care insurance. These policies charge both genders the same prices, making them a better deal for women. Medicare provides short-term care in a facility for a stay of up to 100 days, but not beyond that.



7. You must pass health underwriting to buy long-term care insurance

LTC insurance companies do not accept every applicant. You must meet the health underwriting standards and apply while still reasonably healthy. "You can't wait until you're in a facility and need help paying bills to apply. By then, it's way too late," says Slome. People aged 55 to 69 in reasonably good health are generally the best fit for LTC insurance, says Slome. Eighty is the maximum age to apply at most companies.

Once you qualify for LTC insurance, the coverage is usually guaranteed renewable for your entire life as long as you keep paying the premiums. If you let the policy lapse and reapply, you would need to pass health underwriting again.

8. There are alternative hybrid products

You can buy a life insurance policy that includes long-term care policy coverage. If you need care, the policy pays out some or all of the death benefit while you're still alive. If you pass away without needing long-term care, your heirs receive the full policy death benefit.

"There's a payout either way. It's not a use-it-or-lose-it scenario like stand-alone long-term care insurance," says Jordan Mangaliman, chief executive of Goldline Insurance and Financial Services in Fullerton, California.

You could qualify for life insurance into your seventies if you're in good health, says Mangaliman. Life insurance policies usually pay a lower total benefit for care versus similarly priced LTC insurance policies. You must also read the fine print for when your life insurance would pay.

Another option is to buy an annuity. You pay for the annuity upfront, and in exchange, it gives you future income payments that can be guaranteed to last your entire life. Some annuities offer a long-term care benefit. For example, an

annuity might double your monthly payment for several years when you need long-term care, says Mangaliman. In exchange, adding this benefit could reduce your starting monthly annuity payments.

9. It pays to compare insurers before buying



Each insurance company has its own rates and health underwriting standards. Before signing up, you should get a few quotes from different companies.

Mangaliman suggests using an insurance broker representing multiple insurance companies to speed up the process. When comparing, consider each insurance company's A.M. Best rating for financial stability to pay future claims and J.D. Power score for customer satisfaction.

The long-term care insurance market is small, with only six insurers selling stand-alone policies: Mutual of Omaha, Thrivent, National Guardian Life, New York Life, Northwestern and Bankers Life. In terms of quality, insurers tend to offer similar levels of coverage, and the main difference is the price they quote for you.

"It's not like one company will sell you a Mercedes while another is a Honda. With LTC insurance, they're all Hondas," says Slome.

10. LTC insurance gives you more options for care

If you have a long-term care insurance policy, you have more flexibility to decide how you receive treatment and where. For example, you could spend the money on a home healthcare worker rather than go into a nursing home under Medicaid.

Slome finds that people with insurance are more willing to pay for better care and get help sooner, whereas those without insurance tend to hold off. "If an earthquake destroys my house, I won't cheap out on the repairs because I have homeowner's insurance. People do the same when they have long-term care insurance," he says.

I	K	M	M	D	N	O	D	G	Y	M	A	S	B
J	O	S	A	A	C	L	E	I	T	A	E	N	H
A	C	A	A	E	T	N	D	M	I	N	Y	O	D
C	T	M	E	R	S	M	C	A	V	E	N	W	E
K	F	T	F	B	S	E	O	N	I	G	S	F	C
F	R	S	A	R	E	R	C	G	T	I	A	L	O
R	I	I	M	E	N	R	R	E	A	F	N	A	R
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T	D	C	Y	I	Y	S	K	A	I	N	C	Y	I
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F	J	E	N	I	A	S	S	S	O	O	U	L	S
A	N	G	E	L	C	F	M	J	N	A	S	A	I



Laughter is the Best Medicine

Golden Years

With each wrinkle, a story told,
Treasures lie in the heart, not the gold.
A gentle grace in every sigh,
Wisdom blooms as years slip by.

Each moment cherished, each laugh embraced,
Life's tender dance, a slow-paced grace.
In silvered hair and seasoned hands,
The beauty of age, like timeless sands.

Senior Resource Guide and Important Phone Numbers

Alameda County Adult Protective Services	1 (866) 225-5277
Alameda County Crisis Support Services (24hr)	1 (800) 309-2131
Alameda County In-Home Supportive Services	1 (510) 577-1900
Alameda County Area Agency on Aging	1 (510) 577-3530
Alzheimer's Services of the East Bay	1 (510) 644-8292
American Diabetes Association	1 (510) 654-4499
Arthritis Foundation	1 (888) 391-9389
CA Dept. of Aging	1 (800) 510-2020
California Relay for Hearing Impaired	7-1-1
California Smoker's Helpline	1 (800) 662-8887
Center for Independent Living	1 (510) 841-4776
City of San Leandro Minor Home Repair	1 (510) 625-0316 x102
Consumer Fraud Reporting	1 (415) 553-7400
Covered California Hotline	1 (800) 300-1506
Davis Street Family Resource Center	1 (510) 347-4620
DMV	1 (800) 777-0133
ECHO Housing	1 (510) 581-9380
Emergency Services (Ambulance, Fire and Police)	9-1-1
Family Caregiver Alliance	1 (800) 445-8106
Flex Rides - City of San Leandro	1 (510) 577-7985
Health Insurance Counseling & Advocacy	1 (510) 839-0393
Legal Assistance for Seniors	1 (510) 832-3040
LIFE ElderCare	1 (510) 894-0370
Medi-Cal	1 (510) 670-6000
Mercy Brown Bag Program	1 (510) 534-8540 x369
Mobilehome Assistance Center (Complaints) HCD	(800) 952-8356
Mobilehome Residency Law Protection Program HCD	(800) 952-8356
Ombudsman Program	1 (510) 638-6878
PG&E Smarter Energy Line	1 (800) 933-9555
Paratransit – East Bay Paratransit (AC Transit)	1 (510) 287-5000
San Leandro Adult School	1 (510) 667-6287
San Leandro Marina Community Center	1 (510) 577-3462
San Leandro Senior Community Center	1(510) 577-3462
Senior Legal Hotline of Northern California	1 (800) 222-1753
Social Security Administration	1 (800) 772-1213
S.O.S./Meals on Wheels	1 (510) 582-1263
Spectrum Community Services, Inc.	1 (510) 881-0300
Spectrum Lunch Reservations - San Leandro SCC	1 (510) 825-9793
Supplemental Security Income (SSI)	1 (800) 772-1213
Sutter Care at Home	1 (800) 698-1273
The Friendship Line (Institute on Aging)	1 (800) 971-0016
Traffic and Transit	5-1-1
Veterans Assistance Benefits	1 (800) 827-1000
Well Connected	1 (877) 797-7299
Well Connected en Espaňol	1 (877) 400-5867